SURVEY ANALYSIS · BRIEF

Displaced and host households in Sudan: how they compare

Evidence from 10,735 household interviews in eight states, 2024

Zoi Diamantakou • October 2026

10,735
household interviews, of which 9,977 analysed: 5,963 IDP, 4,014 host

8 states
two rounds, August and November 2024

17 of 24
published figures reproduced from the public data

KEY FINDINGS

1. **Displaced households (IDPs) are worse off than the host households around them on all seven indicators,** each in at least 3 of 8 states; hosts are never clearly worse off. The difference is widest and most consistent for work: in every state, IDP households are 12 to 44 percentage points more likely to have no one earning money.
2. **Conditions do not differ consistently among IDP households.** No group (by sex of respondent, disability or type of shelter) is consistently worse off than other IDPs across states.
3. **IDPs recall a sharp loss of food and work since leaving home.** The share unable to get enough food rose from 3%–20% before displacement to 45%–88% now, and 55%–66% lost at least one personal document.
4. **The public data reproduce 17 of 24 figures in the published report.** The largest difference concerns host communities: in the six states the report covers, 84% of hosts report an urgent need of non-food items, not 34%.

i The survey

The Norwegian Refugee Council (NRC) and local partners interviewed 10,735 households in eight states of Sudan in August and November 2024, for the Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre (IDMC). This brief compares **5,963 IDP households with 4,014 host households** living in the same states; respondents who answered the other group's questions, or none, are left out (see How this was done).

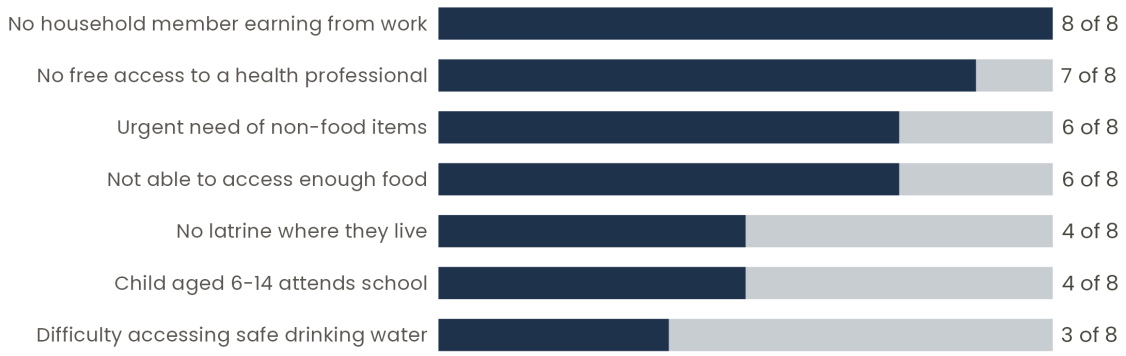
The sample is not random across Sudan and has no weights, so **figures describe the surveyed households only** and are given **state by state**, never as an average for Sudan.

READING THIS BRIEF A difference is called *clear* when its 95% confidence interval excludes zero and it is at least 5 percentage points.

1 How IDP and host households compare

IDP households are worse off than hosts on every indicator, most consistently on work

States (of 8) where IDP households are clearly worse off than host households (navy); grey: no clear difference. Hosts are never clearly worse off.

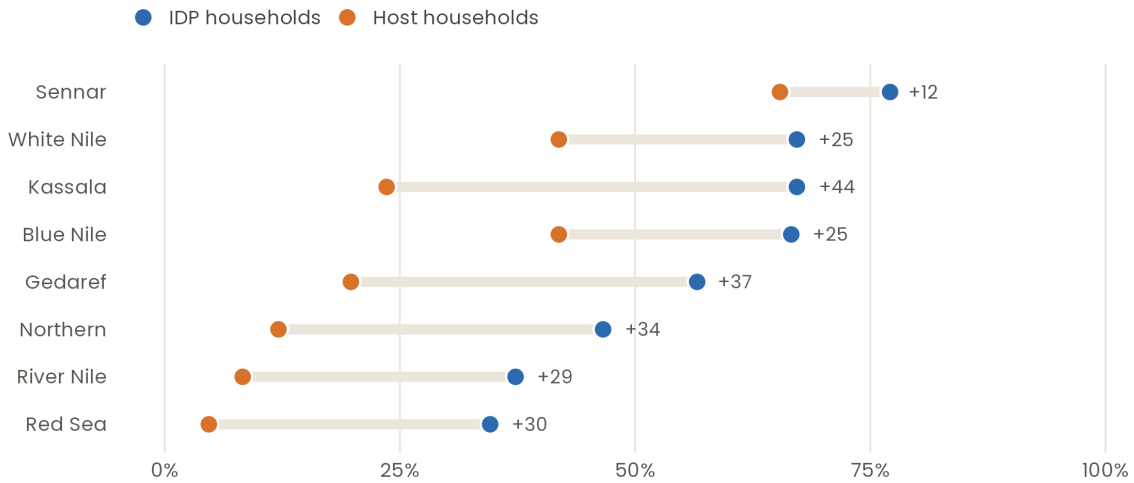


Source: IDMC/NRC household survey, Aug-Nov 2024 (HDX). Unweighted; surveyed sites only, not representative of all IDPs in Sudan. Clear difference: 95% CI excludes 0 and at least 5 points.

IDPs are clearly worse off on **work** in all 8 states, on **free access to a health professional** in 7, on **food** and **urgent need of non-food items** in 6 each, and on **school attendance** and **latrines** in 4. **Safe drinking water** is the exception: in most states IDPs and hosts report similar difficulty.

In every state, IDP households are 12 to 44 points more likely than hosts to have no one earning

Households where no member earns money from work, by state (difference in percentage points)



Source: IDMC/NRC household survey, Aug-Nov 2024 (HDX). Unweighted; surveyed sites only, not representative of all IDPs in Sudan. Clear difference: 95% CI excludes 0 and at least 5 points. All 8 differences are clear.

Where the school differences are clear, they are large: IDP children aged 6–14 are 22 to 38 points less likely to attend school than host children (Gedaref, Northern, Red Sea, River Nile). In Sennar no child in either group attends school (0%). The questionnaire had no answer for schools being closed, which is the likely explanation.

2 Do conditions differ among IDP households?

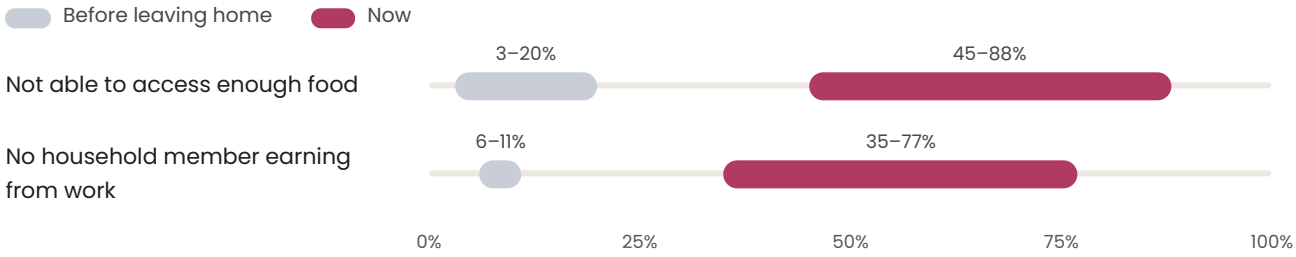
Differences among IDP households are small next to the difference with hosts. Households living in **camps and other sites** are more likely to have no one earning in 3 of 7 states where this can be measured, and households with **a member with a disability** are more likely to lack enough food in 2 of 8. Neither pattern holds in at least half the states, so no group is called *consistently worse off*. Some groups are too small to report in some states (fewer than 30 households), for example rented accommodation in Kassala and White Nile.

3 Before leaving home and now

IDPs were asked about their situation before they left home. These answers are recalled, so they show change as people report it, not as measured at two points in time.

In every state, IDPs recall a sharp loss of food and work

Range across the eight states, share of IDP households (%)



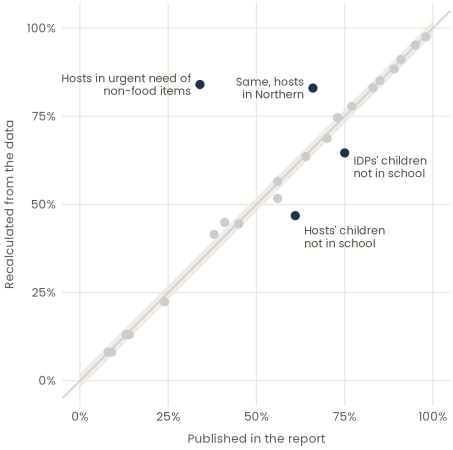
Source: IDMC/NRC household survey, Aug–Nov 2024 (HDX). Recalled answers. Unweighted; surveyed sites only.

55–66% of IDP households lost at least one personal document while displaced, most often **birth certificates and identity cards**.

4 Do the public data match the published report?

The public data reproduce 17 of 24 figures in the published report

Each dot is one figure: as published (across) and recalculated from the data (up). Band: within 2 points.



Source: NRC (2024) Bursting at the seams; IDMC/NRC household survey (HDX). Six August-round states; six-state figures as pooled shares. Navy: not reproduced (more than 5 points apart).

17 within 2 points

3 within 5 points

4 not reproduced

Of 24 figures in the report *Bursting at the seams* that match this brief's indicators, 17 are reproduced within 2 points, 3 within 5, and 4 are not reproduced. The report does not say how its six-state figures are calculated; the result is the same whether they are calculated as pooled shares or as the average of the state shares.

The largest difference is the share of **host households in urgent need of non-food items**: 34% in the report, 84% in the data.

Dividing the number of hosts in need by *all* respondents gives 32.5%, close to the published figure, which suggests a denominator error in the report. This is a hypothesis, not proof.

5 What this means

Livelihoods show the clearest difference.

Support for displaced people to earn an income is the need shared across every state surveyed.

Many host households also report high needs

on food, water and non-food items, and the published figure for non-food items probably understates them.

These data do not support targeting within IDPs by sex, disability or shelter alone;

the state and the IDP–host difference matter more.

6 Limitations

- Not representative of all IDPs or hosts in Sudan; no weights; the November round (River Nile, Sennar) is a different moment of the conflict.
- Self-reported answers; food is measured by simple questions, not standard food security scales.
- Safety and documentation cannot be compared with hosts, who were not asked comparable questions.
- Settlement names are free text, so confidence intervals may be slightly too narrow.
- 515 respondents classed as non-IDPs answered the questions for IDPs, and almost all gave a state of origin, so their status is probably miscoded. Classifying respondents by the questions they answered changes 1 result (water in White Nile).

7 How this was done

Framing | Analysis plan | Data quality | Cleaning | Analysis | Validation | Data protection | Reporting

The analysis follows a documented workflow: a data quality check (46 issues logged, each with a decision), cleaning without editing the raw file, seven indicators chosen against four criteria, comparisons with confidence intervals clustered by settlement, a sensitivity check, validation against the published report, and a disclosure check before publication. The comparison of IDPs with a non-displaced population follows the International Recommendations on IDP Statistics (IRIS); this is not a measure of durable solutions.

Only code and state-level results are published: no household data, place names, free text or language.

Data: IDMC, *Sudan: Socio-Economic Impacts of Internal Displacement*, HDX, licence CC BY 4.0.

Report: NRC (2024), *Bursting at the seams: the impact of war and displacement on Sudan's eastern cities*.

Method and code: github.com/ZoiDiama/survey-analysis-workflow